Casey Caster

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Technology strategy and operations leader with 15+ years running portfolios, governance, and program management offices in cloud infrastructure, enterprise SaaS, and fintech. Today the CTO's chief of staff at SingleStore, a cloud-native database company: runs the engineering operating cadence, capacity planning, and delivery dashboards; manages the engineering budget with Finance; cut internal cloud spend 50%; and stood up the governance and ops program behind internal GenAI adoption. At Ripple, built the global program management function from 4 project managers to 25, plus 75+ engineers and architects, across 800+ implementations. PMP; Executive MBA.

Core Competencies

- **Chief of Staff & Operating Rhythm**: Chief of staff to the CPO and then the CTO; works directly with executives on product, operations, and roadmap strategy; runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards.
- **Technology Portfolio Management & Governance**: Owned programs spanning cost optimization, M&A, governance, and AI platform operations; led Autodesk portfolio optimization across 150+ projects ($2M+ savings); upgraded Wells Fargo's project portfolio systems for 10,000+ vendors.
- **Program Management Office (PMO) Leadership**: Built Ripple's global program management function and leads technical program management at SingleStore; hires and develops program and project managers; Jira, Confluence, Looker, Tableau, Power BI.
- **Financial & Vendor Partnership**: Manages the engineering budget with Finance; built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance; negotiates vendor contracts, including LLM token pricing; SOW and MSA negotiation.
- **AI Adoption & Governance**: Drove internal GenAI adoption through a governance and ops program; leads AI enablement across the development stack, including Claude Code, Amazon Bedrock, Google Vertex AI, and Cursor.
- **Strategic Program Execution & Transformation**: Rescued a failing strategic partner integration ($30M+ recurring ARR); M&A due diligence and integration of acquired teams; agile, digital transformation, and change management.

Professional Experience

- **SingleStore** **San Francisco, CA**
  Sr Director, Engineering - Internal Services & Technical Program Management (CTO Chief of Staff) *2021-Present*
  Strategy and operations for a cloud-native database company in hypergrowth, reporting to the CPO and then the CTO in a chief-of-staff role. Leads seven teams through a director, two managers, a TPM who runs quality assurance, and two principal architects (32 people).
  - **Runs the engineering operating cadence**: capacity planning and delivery dashboards for engineering leadership.
  - **Cut internal cloud spend by 50%** through cross-team policy reform and usage modeling.
  - **Manages the engineering budget with Finance**; built a COGS intelligence engine that aligns growth trends with operational investment decisions.
  - **Drove internal GenAI adoption** with a governance and ops program, creating and launching internal platforms; leads AI tooling across the development stack, including Claude Code.
  - **Unlocked $30M+ in recurring ARR** by stepping into a failing strategic partner integration and leading a cross-functional realignment to delivery.
  - **Launched an internal development platform**, reducing infrastructure bottlenecks by 70%.
  - **De-risked M&A** by leading technical due diligence, then integrating acquired teams into core systems and workflows.
  - **Increased engineering velocity 5x** through agile transformation and accountability systems.

- **Ripple, Inc.** **San Francisco, CA**
  Global Head of Program Management, Customer Success *2016-2020*
  Promoted to lead global delivery programs for RippleNet and architect the implementation function.
  - **Built the program management function** from 4 project managers to three managers of project management and 25 project managers, plus 75+ engineers and architects indirectly.
  - **Delivered 800+ global implementations** and cut customer delivery time from eight months to eight weeks.
  - **Established the RippleNet Committee**, a global governance body, negotiating with C-suite executives of major banks; the network grew to hundreds of members.
  - **Oversaw a joint venture in Japan** that delivered implementations at 68+ additional banks.
- **Wells Fargo Bank** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager *2014-2015*
  - **Delivered a $20M+ digital transformation initiative**, coordinating 300+ testers.
  - **Led an upgrade of project portfolio systems** for 10,000+ vendors.
- **Autodesk** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager, Head of Continuous Improvement *2013-2014*
  - **Led portfolio optimization with $2M+ in savings** and improved user satisfaction.
  - Analyzed 150+ projects and delivered recommendations to improve efficiency and employee engagement.
- **Engajer** **Mountain View, CA**
  Head of Customer Success *2012-2013*
  - Built and led programs supporting 850+ customers; increased revenue 20% per account with 85% retention.
- **Avanade** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Consultant *2010-2012*
  - Led requirements and business analysis for new CRM systems; delivered CRM and communications transformations in utilities and healthcare.

Selected Accomplishments

- **Implemented a $4M virtual testing network program** with teams in Bangalore and London, saving hundreds of person-hours per test cycle.
- **Mentored dozens of team members**, three of whom became CEOs at other companies.

Education & Certifications

- **Executive MBA**, Cornell University (Johnson) and Queen's University (Smith), dual degree
- **BS, Electronic Engineering Technology**, DeVry University, Pomona, CA
- **Project Management Professional (PMP)**, Project Management Institute

References

- Available upon request.